Ignacio Urbina

Stony Brook University
Department of Political Science
Stony Brook, NY 11794
github.com/ignaciourbina

Email: ignacio.urbina@stonybrook.edu
Website:
Scholar: Google Scholar
Teaching: Interactive Tools

Education

2021–*Present*	Ph.D. Candidate, Political Science, State University of New York at Stony Brook, US.*
2015–2016	M.Sc., Master in Economics, Adolfo Ibáñez University, Chile.
2013–2014	M.Sc., Master in Public Policy, Adolfo Ibáñez University, Chile.
2009–2012	B.Sc., Management Science, Adolfo Ibáñez University, Chile.

*Expected graduation: May 2027.

Research

Published Papers

1. Oleg Smirnov, Pei-Hsun Hsieh, & **Ignacio Urbina**. (2025). *Finite pool of worry and emotions in climate change tweets during COVID-19. Journal of Environmental Psychology*, 106, 102728. doi.

Dissertation Research

Three Essays on the Political Implications of AI. Committee: Oleg Smirnov (Chair), Reuben Kline, Andrew Engelhardt.

1. **Ignacio Urbina**. ***The Conditional Activation Model: Uncovering Policy Demand Responses to AI-Driven Automation*** (Job Market Paper).
   - Introduces a two-gate framework explaining when citizens update policy preferences in response to AI-driven job automation risk. Pre-registered experiment with 901 U.S. workers; trust-stratum effects recovered by entropy balancing on pre-treatment covariates.
   - Presented at the 2026 MPSA Meeting and the 2026 APSA Meeting poster session.
2. **Ignacio Urbina**. *Simulating Open Democracy: An Agent-Based Framework for Testing Deliberative Institutional Designs*.
   - Open-source simulation using LLM agents as synthetic citizens to test how different institutional rules impact democratic consensus. Presented at the 2026 MPSA Meeting.
3. **Ignacio Urbina** & Oleg Smirnov. *Beyond Pro- and Anti-AI: The Structure of Artificial Intelligence Attitudes in Mass Publics*.
   - Maps the structure of U.S. public attitudes toward AI with exploratory factor analysis on a nationally representative sample (N = 5,153): fifty-two items resolve into ten factors organized by the social context of deployment, a belief-system network with no general-attitude hub, and demographic cleavages that reverse direction across dimensions.
   - Presented at the 2024 MPSA Meeting.

Under Review

1. **Ignacio Urbina** & Vitória Sgorlon. *Fractured Trust: The Spillover Effects of Police Violence on Satisfaction with Democracy and Political Trust*. Under review at *American Political Science Review*.

- Three studies: two-wave survey experiment in Brazil (N = 1,004), observational analysis of Chile's 2019 protest repression, and cross-national LAPOP analysis of sixteen Latin American countries.
- Presented at the 2024 Society of Political Methodology Conference, the 2024 Human Rights Measurement Workshop at the University of Rhode Island, the 2024 MPSA Meeting, and the 2024 APSA Meeting.
- Winner of the Best Poster Award at the 2023 Latin American Political Methodology Meeting.
- Awarded with the 2022 Stony Brook University Fine Arts, Humanities, and Social Sciences Research Grant ($4,000).

2. **Ignacio Urbina**, Akhil Ponda, & Reuben Kline. *Communication and Cooperation with Human and Artificial Agents*. Under review at *Behaviour & Information Technology*.
   - 2x2 factorial behavioral experiment (oTree): human vs. AI partner, with vs. without communication, in one shot Prisoner's Dilemma and Stag Hunt games.
   - Presented at the 2023 APSA Meeting, Oxford's Talking to Machines Workshop (May 2024), and the 2024 IMEBESS Conference.

Working Papers

1. **Ignacio Urbina**. *Automation Risk, Redistribution, and Economic Vulnerability: Evidence from the European Social Survey, 2002–2022*
   - Develops a formal insurance model and tests it on more than 270,000 respondents in 35 countries. Finds that automation risk predicts support for redistribution through 2012 and that the link disappears in the decade after. Traces the change to welfare state design. Earnings related benefits strengthen the link, and flat transfers weaken it.

2. **Ignacio Urbina**. *Repressive Democracies: State Repression, Protest, and Policy Change*.
   - Develops a global game in which an elected executive sets protest policing before mobilization. Budget pressure raises authorized harm where costs lie in deployment and lowers it where the same inputs implement force.

Work in Progress

1. Oleg Smirnov & **Ignacio Urbina**. *Public Attitudes Toward Artificial General Intelligence and Superintelligent AI*.
   - Original survey instrument with novel question battery, fielded on Prolific (N $\sim$ 900). Data collection finished.
   - Awarded with the 2022 Stony Brook University Fine Arts, Humanities, and Social Sciences Research Grant ($3,500).

2. **Ignacio Urbina**, Daniel Araya, Robert Vidigal, & Angelika Sharygina. *Mind Under Pressure: Does Cognitive Overload Increase Susceptibility to Misinformation?*
   - Pre-registered 2x3 factorial survey experiment testing whether an LLM assistant reduces misinformation susceptibility under cognitive overload.

3. Alexa Bankert, Reuben Kline, **Ignacio Urbina**, Thomas McDonough, & John Kane. *Minding The (Experimental) Gap(s): Prosociality with Real and Hypothetical Stakes in the Lab and Online*.
   - Behavioral experiment comparing prosociality with real vs. hypothetical stakes across lab and online settings. Replication with new data collection upcoming.

4. Anakiz Elif Senturk, Vitória Sgorlon, A. Echeverri, & **Ignacio Urbina**. *Do Job Worries Follow the Numbers? Correcting Beliefs about Immigrants' Share of the Workforce*.
   - Four-arm pre-registered experiment (N = 1,641 U.S. workers) testing whether occupation-specific or national facts about immigrants in the workforce reduce perceived economic threat and shift immigration attitudes.
   - Submitted to the 2027 MPSA Meeting.

5. **Ignacio Urbina**. *Bots, Collective Action, and Social Media: An Agent-Based Model of Adversarial Suppression in Polarized Networks.*
   - Agent based model of bot manipulation in social networks.
6. Tom McDonough, Reuben Kline, **Ignacio Urbina**, William Brown, & Josh McDonnell. *Does Social Signaling in a Public Goods Game Encourage Pareto Optimality or Detrimental Freeriding?*

Non-peer Reviewed Publications

1. **Urbina, I.** (2022). Chile's 2019 Social Uprising: Social Movements as Drivers of Public Opinion. The Stony Brook Worker. Fall 2022, Issue 2. Accessible at: https://stonybrookworker.com/issues/sbw-issue-2/chiles-2019-social-uprising-social-movements-as-drivers-of-public-opinion.
2. **Urbina, I.**, & Sugg, D. (2021, June). Análisis de la eficiencia de los hospitales públicos de alta complejidad en Chile entre 2014 y 2018. Estudios de Finanzas Publicas, Dirección de Presupuestos, Ministerio de Hacienda, Chile. Accessible at: https://www.dipres.gob.cl/598/articles-232639_doc_pdf.pdf.

Professional Experience

2025–*Present*	**Lab Manager** - Behavioral Political Economy Lab (BPEL), Stony Brook University. Supervisor: Prof. Reuben Kline (Ph.D. Political Science, UC Irvine). Coordinate between 4 and 10 research assistants; manage lab operations, onboarding, and project workflows for behavioral experiments. Built full-stack participant recruitment and management system.
2022–May 23'	**Research Assistant** - Supervisors: Prof. Oleg Smirnov (Ph.D. Political Science, U. of Oregon), & Prof. Reuben Kline (Ph.D. Political Science, UC Irvine).
May 2018–May 21'	**Economic Analyst** - Research Department of the Budget Office of the Chilean Ministry of Finance.
May 2017–Oct 17'	**Consultant** - InnovacionAL SPA.
Dec 2012–Feb 13'	**Intern** - Deloitte Chile, Finance Transformation Consulting.
2014–2018	**Research Assistant** - Supervisors: Prof. Alejandro Montecinos (Ph.D. in Economics, Notre Dame), Prof. Guillermo Paraje (Ph.D. in Economics, Cambridge), Prof. Matías Braun (Ph.D. in Economics, Harvard), & Prof. Claudio Agostini (Ph.D. in Economics, U. of Michigan).

Conferences and Presentations

Presenter: NYAAPOR Young Public Opinion Scholars Competition (2026), APSA (2026, 24'), MPSA (2026, 24'), IMEBESS (2024), ISPP (2024), Chilean Political Science Meeting (2024, 18'), IPSA World Congress (2023), SBU Graduate Sociology Students Colloquium (2023), Vanderbilt University's LAPOP Summer School Workshop Session (2023), Chilean Society for Public Policy Meeting (2016, 14'), Economics Chilean Society Anual Meeting (2016).

Discussant: MPSA (2024), IPSA World Congress, Buenos Aires (2023), APSA (2024).

Panel Co-Organizer: APSA (2024).

Non-presenter co-author: Poster Session POLMETH (2024), Human Rights Workshop at URI (2024), APSA (2023), Poster Session - Latin American Political Methodology Meeting (2023).

Grants, Awards, and Fellowships

2026 NYAAPOR Young Public Opinion Scholars Competition Finalist

2024 Milton Lodge Graduate Research Scholarship ($500)

2024 NSF BIAS-NRT Travel Grant ($1,100)

2023 Latin American Political Methodology Meeting Best Poster Award ($200)

2023 GSEU Professional Development Award ($355)

2023 Stony Brook University Political Science Department Koppelman Fellowship ($3,000)

2022 Stony Brook University Fine Arts, Humanities, and Social Sciences Grant ($4,000)

2022 Stony Brook University Fine Arts, Humanities, and Social Sciences Grant ($3,500)

2021 Stony Brook University College of Arts and Sciences Fellowship ($3,000)

2014 Best GPA of the Master's in Public Policy. School of Government, Adolfo Ibáñez University (2014 Cohort)

2011, 10', & 09' Academic Honor Scholarship. School of Business, Adolfo Ibáñez University. Awarded to top-performing students based on GPA

Teaching

Instructor of Record

Stony Brook University	Math Camp for Incoming Ph.D. Students	26', 25', 24' Fall
	Intro. to Statistical Methods in Political Science	25', 24' Summer, 25' Spring, 26' Winter
	Introductory Statistics	2024 Fall
Finis Terrae University	Behavioral Economics	2020, 19', 18'
	Microeconomics	2018, 17', 16'
	Introduction to Economics	2016
Adolfo Ibáñez University	Industrial Organization	2016
	Microeconomics I	2016

Teaching Assistant

Stony Brook University	World Politics	2022 Spring
	Introduction to American Government	2021 Fall
Adolfo Ibáñez University	Econometrics	2015
	Impact Evaluation for Public Policies	2014, 15'
	Chilean Economics	2015
	Intermediate Macroeconomics	2015
	Mathematical Economics	2013
	Calculus III	2013
	Industrial Organization	2013
	Introduction to Macroeconomics	2011
	Introduction to Microeconomics	2011
	Introduction to Economics	2010

Professional Service

Journal Reviewer: *Research & Politics*, *PLOS One*, *Communications Psychology*.

Additional Training, Skills, and Others

Traineeship:	NSF Research Traineeship Detecting and Addressing Bias in Data, Humans, and Institutions at Stony Brook University (2023-*Present*)
Summer Schools:	Vanderbilt University's LAPOP Summer School in International Survey Methods (June 2023).
Short Courses:	Response Item Network (ResIN) Analysis of Political Attitude Data, APSA (2026); Introduction to Bayesian Analysis and Bayesian Model Averaging in Stata, APSA (2024).
Methods:	Survey experiments, causal inference, multilevel modeling, Bayesian statistics, formal modeling, agent-based modeling, computational text analysis, network analysis, factor analysis and measurement models, machine learning, data visualization.
Software:	*Python* (advanced), *R* (advanced), *Stata* (advanced), *TypeScript/Node.js* (Claude Code, Codex – Agentic Pair Programming), oTree (advanced), Qualtrics (advanced), Connect, Prolific, LaTeX, PostgreSQL, Supabase, Heroku.
Other:	Elected Vice-president of the first Student Government Board at Adolfo Ibáñez University (2012).
	Graduate Student Organization Senator, Department of Political Science, Stony Brook University (2023-2024).

Research Tools

Since 2023, I have integrated AI-assisted tools into my research workflow. AI will transform how researchers process information, organize collective knowledge, and communicate findings. This has led me to build a set of open-source tools that support different stages of the research cycle:

Experiments:	oBots (oTree bot testing), bpel-lab-games (oTree implementation for the cooperation and communication with LLMs experiments), qualtrics-builder (programmatic Qualtrics QSF survey generation), bpe-lab.com, a full stack participant recruitment and management system I built for the BPEL.
Analysis:	SAR Framework (agentic literature review pipeline), irb-client (IRB protocol automation), osf-tool (pre-registration drafting).
Productivity:	agentic-WeekPlanner (planning system with AI chat), clio-assistant (agentic project management with LLM orchestrator).
Teaching:	21 public, open source interactive statistics tools on HuggingFace Spaces. CausalFlow (visual DAG specification).